Year 5 Admission Assessment

Version 3.1, October 2026

Name	
Date	

Welcome!

These activities help us get to know you. Do your best. It is fine if you cannot answer every question. You can ask your teacher to say the instructions again.

How to answer

Tick one box. Which one is an animal? a chair ☐ a cat ☑

Write your answer in the box. 5 + 3 = **8**

Circle the biggest number. 4 (9) 6

Join the picture to its word.



Show your working. 26 + 17 = **43**

Working: 20 + 10 = 30 6 + 7 = 13 30 + 13 = 43

The parts of this booklet

Part		Time
1	Listening	5 minutes
2	Reading	12 minutes
3	Writing	10 minutes
4	Maths	18 minutes
5	Science	8 minutes

Your teacher will tell you when to start each part.

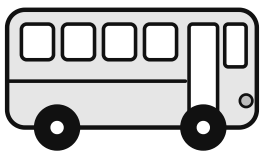
Part 1: Listening

Your teacher will read the questions to you. Then your teacher will read a text **two times**.

Listen carefully. **Answer** the questions on this page and the next page.

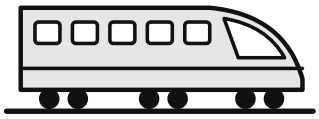
1 / 1

How will the class travel to the museum? **Tick** one box.



bus

A ☐



train

B ☐

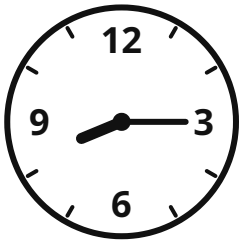


car

C ☐

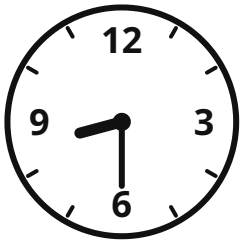
2 / 1

What time does the bus leave school? **Tick** one box.



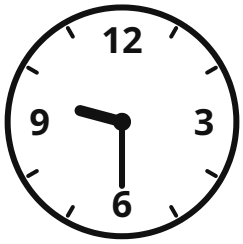
8:15

A ☐



8:30

B ☐



9:30

C ☐

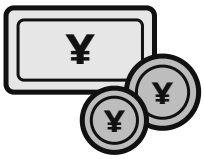
3 / 1

What must the children bring? **Tick** two boxes.



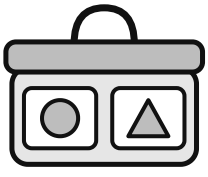
water bottle

A ☐



money

B ☐



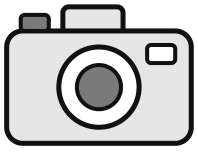
lunch box

C ☐



umbrella

D ☐

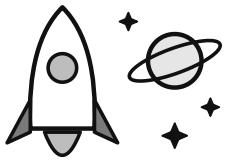


camera

E ☐

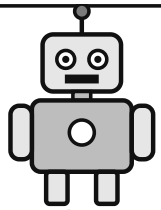
4 / 1

What will the class visit first? **Tick** one box.



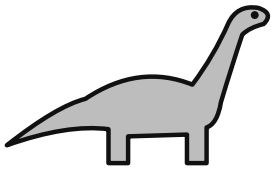
space

A ☐



robots

B ☐



dinosaurs

C ☐

5 / 1

How many children will be in each group?

Write your answer in the box. ☐

6 / 1

How much does the trip cost?

Write your answer in the box. ¥ ☐

7 / 1

Mr Chen says, "Don't worry if it rains." Why does he say this?

Write your answer.

8 / 1

Will the children buy lunch at the museum? **Tick** one box. Yes ☐ No ☐

How do you know? **Write** your answer.

Stop here. Wait for your teacher.

Part 2: Reading

Read the texts and **answer** the questions.

Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish.

Part A

Read the notice. Then answer questions 1 to 6.

Green Lake Park
Children's Garden

Open every day: 8:00 to 18:00

In the garden, you can:


play on the swings


have a picnic


feed the ducks

Please do not:


ride a bike


pick the flowers


swim in the lake

Duck food: ¥2 a bag. You can buy it at the café.

Lost something? Please ask at the office by the main gate.

1 / 1

What time does the garden open in the morning? **Tick** one box.

☐ 6:00 ☐ 8:00 ☐ 18:00

2

/ 2

Tick the **three** things you can do in the garden.



swings ☐



ride a bike ☐



picnic ☐



pick flowers ☐



feed ducks ☐



swim ☐

3

/ 1

How much is one bag of duck food?

Write your answer in the box. ¥ ☐

4

/ 1

Where can you buy duck food?

Write your answer in the box. ☐

5

/ 2

Tick True or False.

	True	False
Example: There are swings in the garden.	☑	☐
You can swim in the lake.	☐	☐
The garden is open on Sundays.	☐	☐

6

/ 1

Tom lost his hat in the garden. Where should he ask?

Write your answer in the box. ☐

Part B

Read the text. Then answer questions 7 to 14.

Silkworms

Silkworms are small insects. Many children in China keep silkworms at school or at home.

A silkworm starts life as a tiny egg. The egg is smaller than a grain of rice. After about ten days, a baby silkworm comes out of the egg. It is black and very thin.

Silkworms eat only one kind of food: mulberry leaves. They eat and eat, day and night, and they grow very fast. After about four weeks, a silkworm is as long as your finger, and it is white.

Then the silkworm stops eating. It makes a long, thin thread of silk. It turns round and round and wraps the thread around its body. This is called a cocoon. The thread can be hundreds of metres long!

Inside the cocoon, the silkworm changes. After about two weeks, a white moth comes out. The moth cannot fly. It lays eggs, and then the life cycle starts again.

People use the thread from cocoons to make silk for clothes.

7 / 1

How big is a silkworm egg? **Tick** one box.

- ☐ bigger than a grain of rice
- ☐ smaller than a grain of rice
- ☐ as long as your finger

8 / 1

How many days does it take for a baby silkworm to come out of the egg?

Write your answer in the box.

About ☐ days

9 / 1

What colour is a baby silkworm?

Write your answer in the box.

☐

10 / 1

What do silkworms eat?

Write your answer in the box.

☐

11

/ 1

"They eat and eat, day and night." What does this tell you about silkworms? **Tick** one box.

☐ They sleep a lot. ☐ They eat a lot. ☐ They eat only at night.

12

/ 1

Find and copy one word from the text that means "very small".

tiny

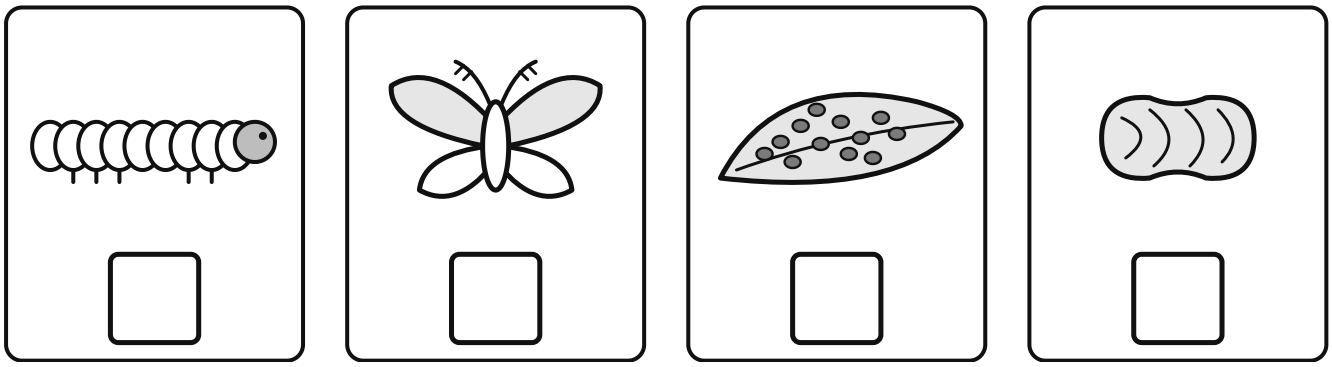
Find and copy one word from the text. It is the name of the silk covering that the silkworm makes around its body.

13

/ 1

These pictures show the life of a silkworm. They are in the wrong order.

Write the numbers 1, 2, 3 and 4 in the boxes to show the right order. Number 1 is the first.



14

/ 1

What do people make from the thread of cocoons?

Write your answer in the box.

Part C

Read the story. Then answer questions 15 to 22.

The Snowman at the Window

When Chen Yu woke up, his bedroom was strangely bright. He pulled back the curtain. Snow! It covered the courtyard like a thick white blanket, and more was still falling, soft and silent.

He pulled on his coat, his hat and two pairs of gloves, and raced down the stairs. His plan was simple: he would build the biggest snowman in the whole building.

He rolled a ball of snow across the courtyard. It grew and grew until it was almost too heavy to push. Panting, he stopped to rest beside the ground-floor window of Mrs Zhao's flat.

Mrs Zhao was eighty-two. Her legs were not strong any more, so when the ground was icy she stayed indoors. Chen Yu could see her sitting by the window, wrapped in a grey shawl, watching the snow. She looked small and still.

Chen Yu looked at his huge snowball in the middle of the courtyard. Then he looked at Mrs Zhao's window again.

He left the giant snowball where it was. Right in front of her window, he started again. This snowman was much smaller, but he worked on it carefully. He gave it two black stones for eyes, a carrot for a nose and his own red scarf.

When it was finished, he tapped on the glass. Mrs Zhao looked up, and her whole face changed. She laughed and pressed her hand against the window, and Chen Yu waved back.

Later, his mother asked him why he had not finished the biggest snowman in the building.

Chen Yu smiled. "I made a better one," he said.

15 / 1

What did Chen Yu plan to build?

Write your answer in the box. _____

16 / 1

Why did Mrs Zhao stay indoors when the ground was icy?

17 / 1

Find and copy one word from the first paragraph that tells you the snow made no sound.

18 / 1

"**Panting**, he stopped to rest." What does **panting** mean here? **Tick** one box.

- ☐ breathing fast and hard
- ☐ laughing loudly
- ☐ feeling cold
- ☐ singing quietly

19 / 1

"She looked small and still." What does this tell you about Mrs Zhao? **Tick** one box.

- ☐ She was lonely and a little sad.
- ☐ She was excited about the snow.
- ☐ She was angry with Chen Yu.
- ☐ She was busy cooking.

20 / 1

How did Mrs Zhao feel when she saw the snowman? How do you know?

21 / 1

Why did Chen Yu build the small snowman in front of Mrs Zhao's window?

22 / 1

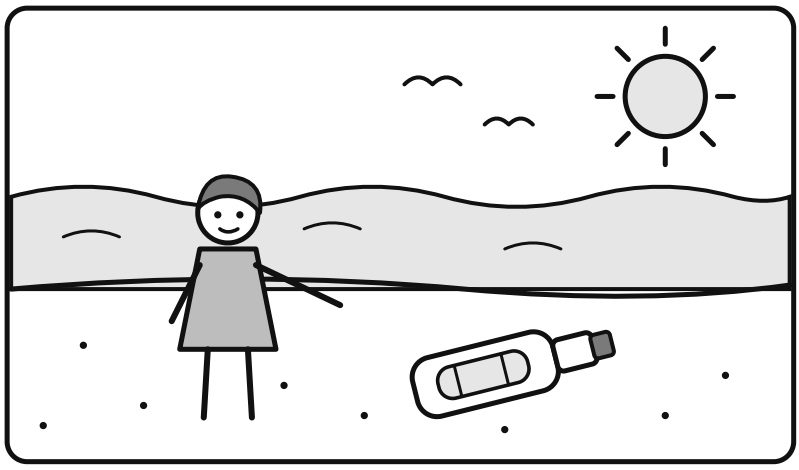
Chen Yu says, "I made a better one." Why do you think he says the small snowman is better?

Stop here. Wait for your teacher.

Part 3: Writing

You have 10 minutes. **Choose** A or B. **Tick** the one you choose.

☐ **A The message in the bottle**



Write a story about this picture. These questions can help you:

- Who finds the bottle?
- What does the message say?
- What happens next?
- How does your story end?

☐ **B My favourite place**

Write about your favourite place. These questions can help you:

- Where is it?
- What can you see, hear and smell there?
- What do you do there? Who do you go with?
- Why do you like it?

Plan

You can write words or draw pictures to plan.

Plan

Write here

Stop here. Wait for your teacher.

Part 4: Maths

You have 18 minutes. You can use a pencil, a rubber and a ruler. You cannot use a calculator.

You can ask your teacher to read a question to you. **Write** your answers in the boxes. You can use the working boxes.

Section A: Number problems

1 / 1

356 + 238 = ☐

Working

2 / 1

7 × 8 = ☐

3 / 1

5 024 – 1 760 =

☐

Working

4 / 1

12 × 6 = ☐

5 / 1

243 × 4 = ☐

Working

6 / 1

Write this fraction as a decimal.

$\frac{47}{100}$ = ☐

7 / 1

Write the missing number.

$$\frac{3}{4} = \frac{\square}{12}$$

8 / 2

27 rounded to the nearest 10 is **30**

Round 4 362 to the nearest:

10	
100	
1 000	

9 / 1

$36 \times 24 =$ ☐

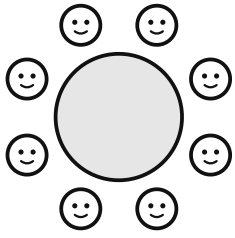
Working

Section B: Word problems and pictures

10 / 1

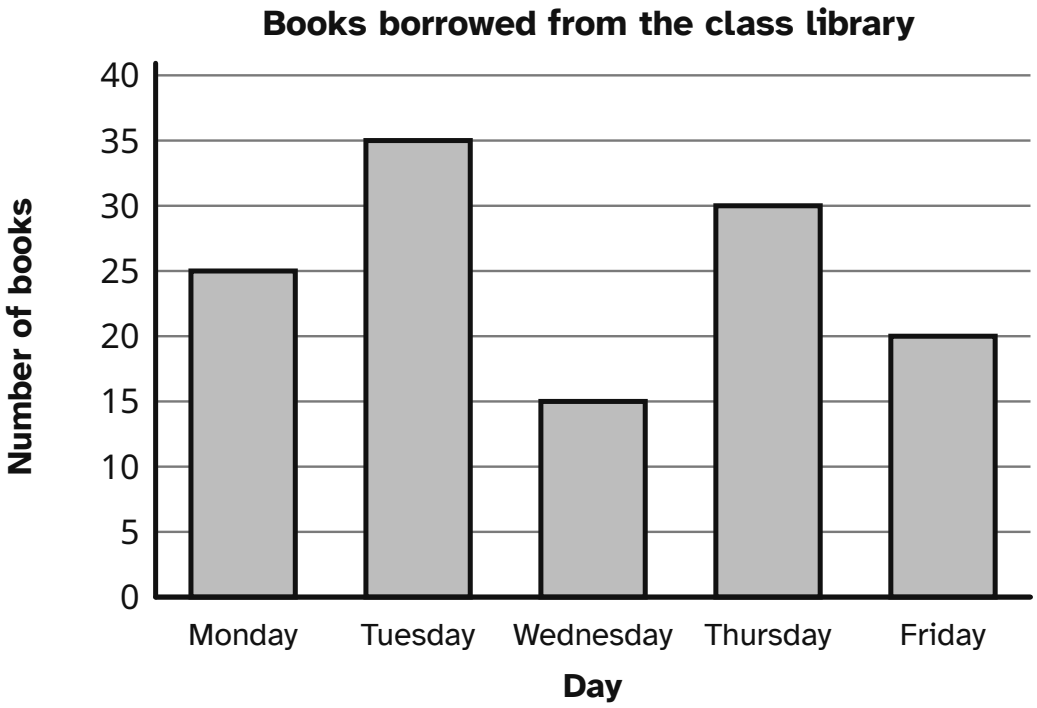
There are 96 children. 8 children sit at each table.

How many tables do they need?



☐ tables

11 / 2



(a) How many books were borrowed on Tuesday? ☐

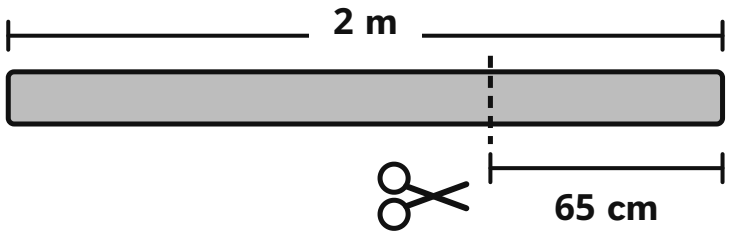
(b) How many **more** books were borrowed on Thursday than on Wednesday?

☐

12 / 1

Sofia has a ribbon. It is 2 m long. She cuts off 65 cm.

How long is the ribbon now? **Write** your answer in cm.



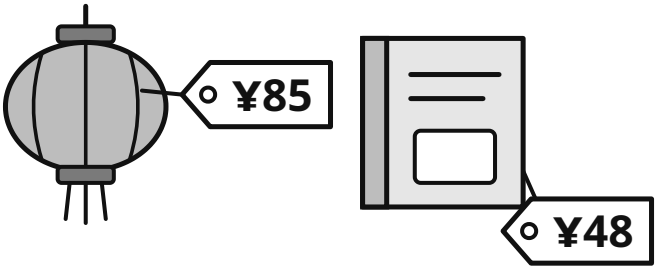
☐ cm

13

/ 2

Mei has ¥250. She buys a lantern and a book.

How much money does she have left?



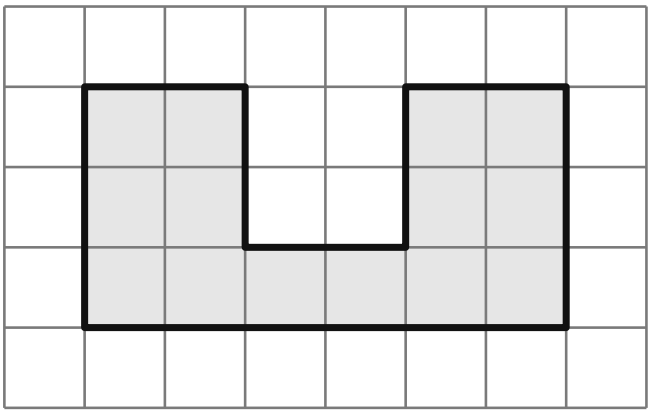
Working

¥ ____

14

/ 2

The shape is drawn on a grid. Each square is 1 cm by 1 cm.



(a) What is the **area** of the shape? ____ cm^2

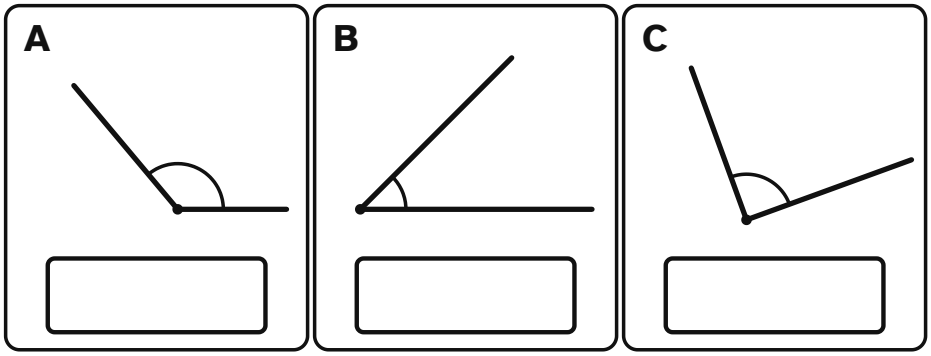
(b) What is the **perimeter** of the shape? ____ cm

15

/ 1

Write acute, obtuse or right in the box under each angle.

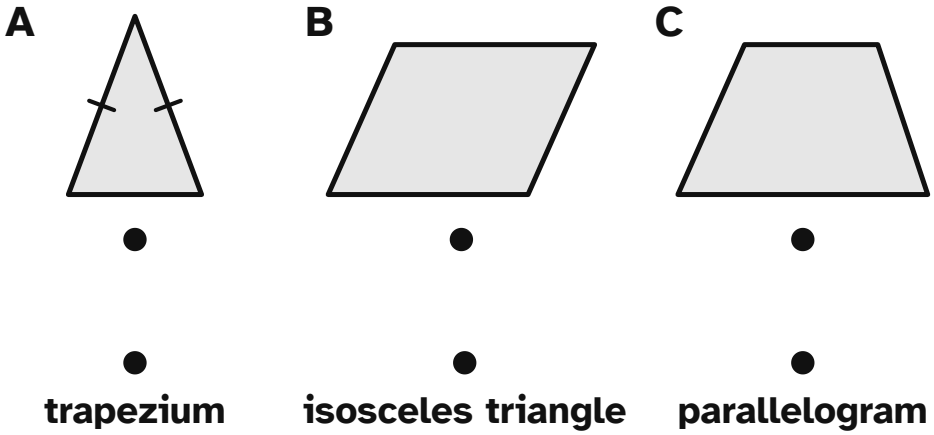
Use these words: **acute** **obtuse** **right**



16

/ 1

Join each shape to its name. Draw a line from dot to dot.

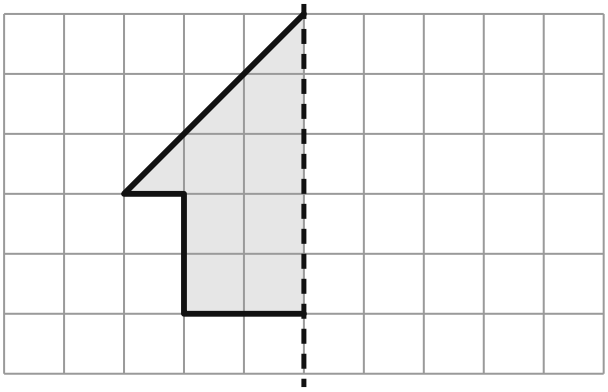


17

/ 1

The dashed line is a line of symmetry.

Draw the other half of the shape. You can use a ruler.



line of symmetry

18

/ 2

Point **E** is at (6, 1). Go 6 across, then 1 up.

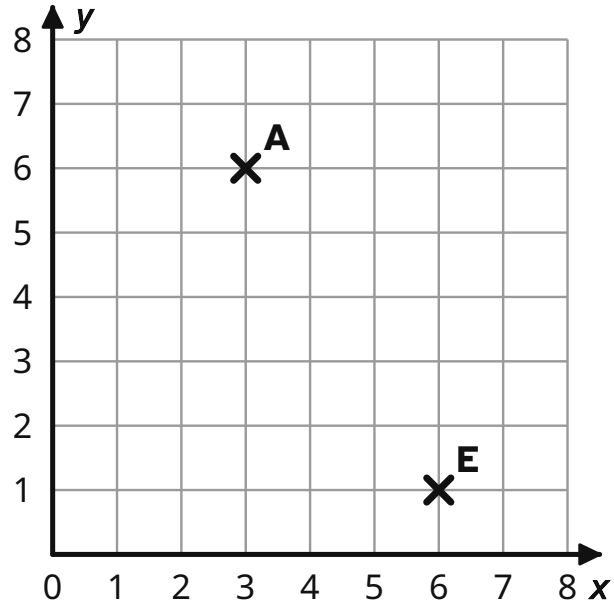
(a) **Write** the coordinates of point **A**.

(☐ , ☐)

(b) Point **A** moves 4 squares to the right and 2 squares down.

Write the new coordinates of point **A**.

(☐ , ☐)



19

/ 2

This thermometer shows the temperature in Harbin at 7 am.

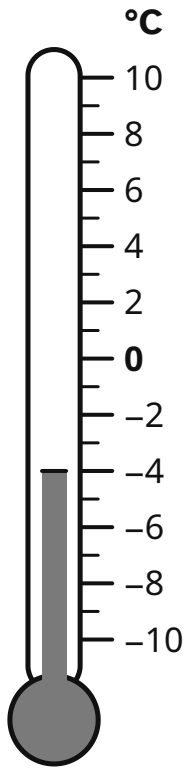
(a) What is the temperature?

☐ °C

(b) By 12 noon, the temperature goes up by 7 degrees.

What is the temperature at 12 noon?

☐ °C



Stop here. Wait for your teacher.

Part 5: Science

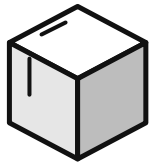
You have 8 minutes. You can ask your teacher to read a question to you.

1 / 1

Write solid, liquid or gas in each box.

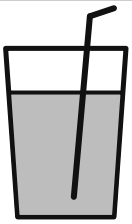
Use these words: **solid** **liquid** **gas**

A



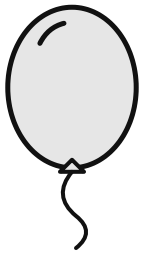
ice

B



orange juice

C



air in a balloon

2 / 1

Join each tooth to its job. Draw a line from dot to dot.



incisor ● ● tears food

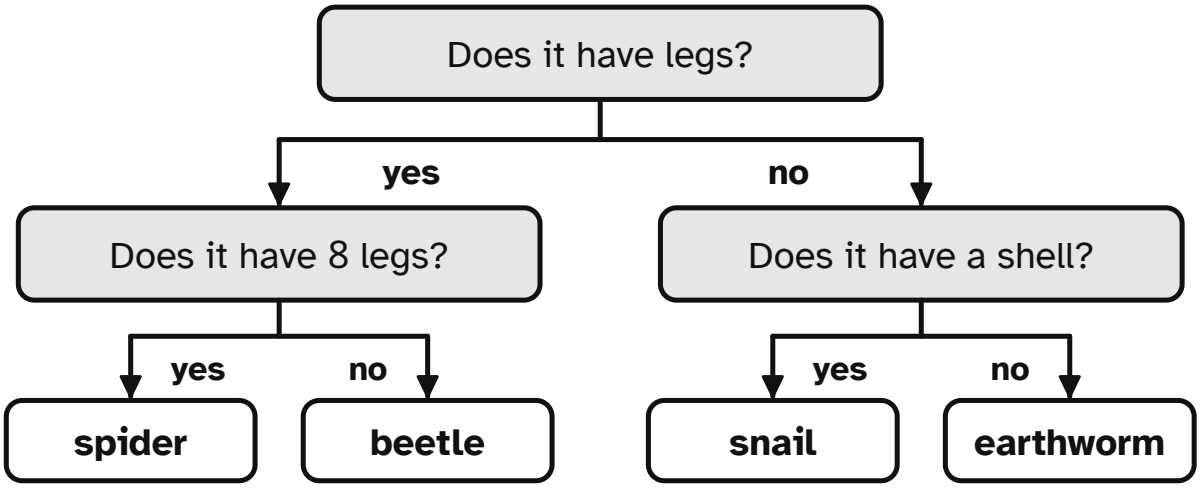
canine ● ● chews and crushes food

molar ● ● cuts food

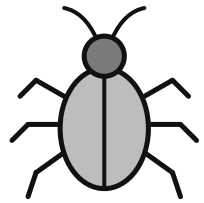
3

/ 1

Use the key to find the name of animal A and animal B.



A



B

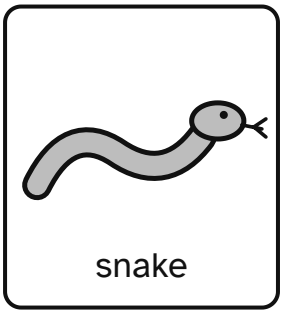


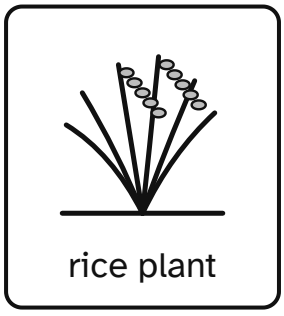
Animal A: _____ Animal B: _____

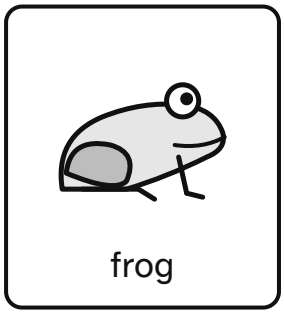
4

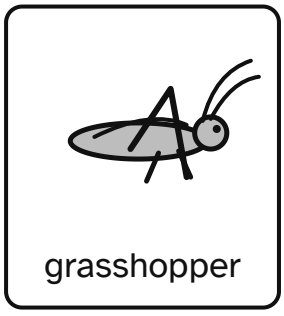
/ 2

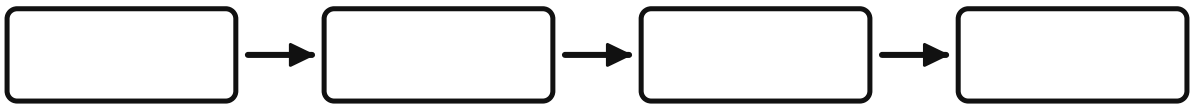
In a food chain, the arrow → means "is eaten by". grass → rabbit → fox


snake


rice plant


frog


grasshopper



(a) **Write** the food chain from a rice field in the boxes.

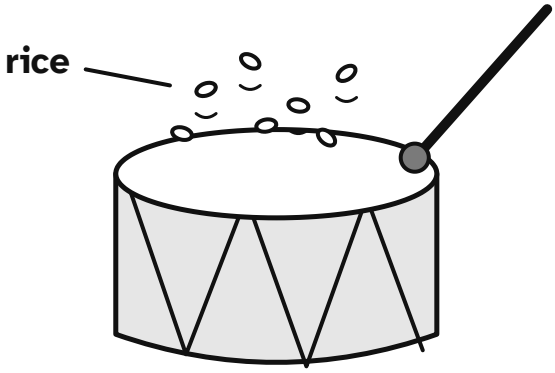
(b) All the frogs leave the rice field. What will happen to the number of grasshoppers? **Tick** one box.

☐ more grasshoppers ☐ fewer grasshoppers ☐ the same

5

/ 1

Chen Yu puts some rice on a drum. He hits the drum. The rice jumps up.



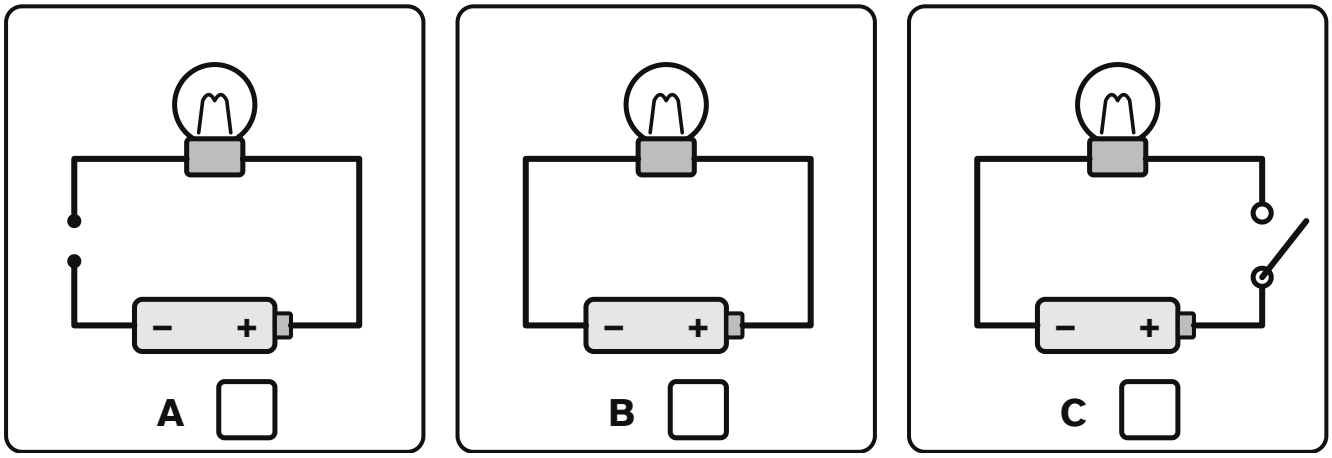
Why does the rice jump? **Tick** one box.

- ☐ The stick hits the rice.
- ☐ The top of the drum vibrates (moves up and down very fast).
- ☐ Wind blows the rice.

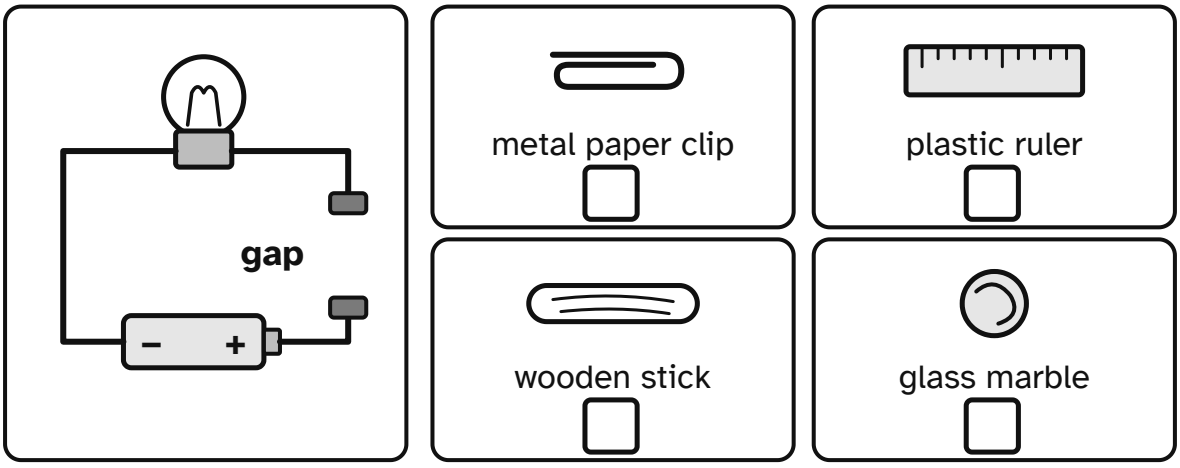
6

/ 2

(a) Which bulb will light? **Tick** one box.



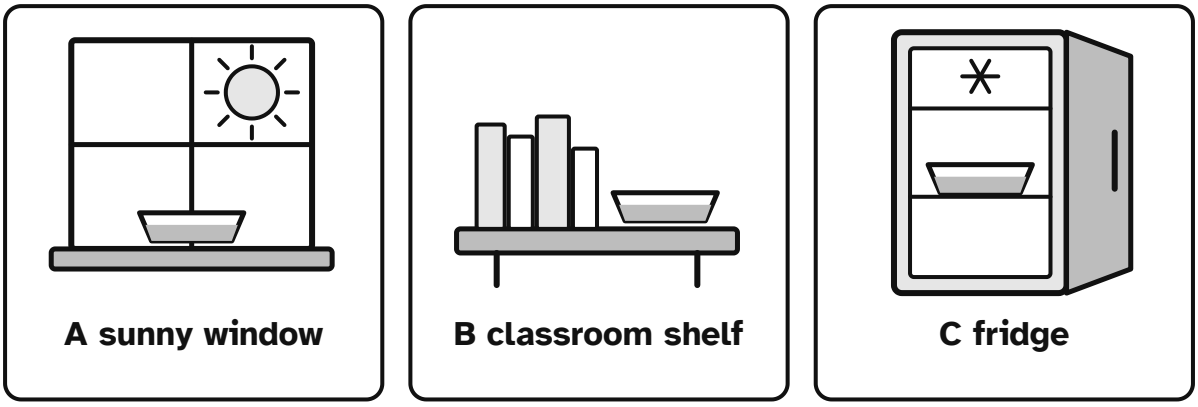
(b) Amir puts different things in the gap in this circuit. Which thing will make the bulb light? **Tick** one box.



7 / 2

Amir puts 100 ml of water in three dishes. He puts the dishes in three places.

After 2 days, he measures the water in each dish.



A sunny window

B classroom shelf

C fridge

Place	Water at the start	Water after 2 days
A sunny window	100 ml	40 ml
B classroom shelf	100 ml	70 ml
C fridge	100 ml	95 ml

(a) In which place did the water evaporate the **fastest**?

(b) Amir wants a fair test. **Write** one thing he must keep the same.

Thank you. You have finished. Please wait for your teacher.

Year 5 Admission Assessment v3.1: assessor booklet

Version 3.1, October 2026. Same content as version 1. Use with `Y05/Y05_Student_Paper_v3.1`; do not mix versions.

For staff only. Use with the Year 5 student paper (`Y05/Y05_Student_Paper_v3.1`), the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card` and `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record`) and the interview record for Years 5 and 6 (`forms/Interview_Record_Y5_Y6`). The whole process, the English proficiency bands and the decision guide are in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`.

Who this is for. Students joining UK Year 5 (age 9 to 10 in September). A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 3** (三年级); a student joining mid-year is partway through Grade 4. The maths tests UK Year 4 content, with a few easier and a few harder items. The science tests UK Year 4 science and working scientifically.

1. At a glance

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Student needs	Student paper pages
1	Welcome	2	Assessor (2.2)		1 (cover)
2	Listening	5	Assessor reads the script (3.1)	pencil	2 to 3
3	Reading paper, Parts A, B and C	12	Student alone; assessor keeps time (3.2)	pencil	4 to 9
4	Writing	10	Student alone (3.3)	pencil	10 to 11
	Break	3 to 5		water	
5	Maths	18	Student alone; assessor may read questions aloud (4)	pencil, rubber, ruler; no calculator, no protractor	12 to 17
6	Science	8	Student alone; assessor may read questions aloud (5)	pencil	18 to 21
7	Interview, opening with the sentence reading screen (start at **Level 4**)	12	Interviewer, 1:1 (3.4, 3.5)	sentence reading card; a plain card to cover sentences	
	Total student time	**about 65**, plus the break			

Print for each student: the student paper (21 pages, A4, printed at actual size: switch off "fit to page", because the diagrams and the type sizes depend on it); the sentence reading record; the interview record; the score summary (Section 6 of this booklet). **For each room:** a laminated sentence reading card, a clock or timer, spare pencils. The written papers can be taken in a small group with one invigilator; listening is read to the group; the interview is always 1:1.

Marks at a glance: listening / 8, reading / 24, writing / 16, maths / 25 (number problems / 10, word problems and pictures / 15, of which word problems / 5), science / 10.

2. Before you start

2.1 Set up

- A quiet, bright room. The student sits where they cannot see other students' papers.

- Write the student's name on the paper if they cannot (in English, with the Chinese name in brackets if the family uses one).
- Have this booklet open at 3.1 for the listening script, and a timer ready.

2.2 Welcome (say this)

> "Hello, I am _____. Welcome to our school. Today you will do some activities: listening, reading, writing, maths and science. Then we will have a chat. The activities help us get to know you and plan how to help you. Some parts are easy and some parts are hard. That is fine. Do your best. If you do not understand what to do, you can ask me to say it again."

Show the cover page. Point to the "How to answer" examples and say: "Look. You tick a box, write in a box, circle, join with a line, and show your working like this."

2.3 Access rules (the same in every year group)

	English parts (listening, reading, writing, sentence reading)	**Maths and science**
Reading aloud	Read only what the script says. Do not explain words, translate, or read the reading texts or reading questions aloud. The student may ask for instructions to be repeated in English.	Read any question aloud in English, as often as the student asks, and point to the picture.
Chinese	Not used by staff.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student clearly cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question **once** in Chinese. Write **L** in the margin. The mark still counts.
Answers	In English only. An answer in Chinese scores 0.	In English only: numbers, words, ticks, drawings and working all count. An answer or explanation in Chinese scores 0.
Not yet taught		If the student says they have not learnt a topic, write **NT** beside the question. It scores 0, and the summary lists the NT topics.

Extra time or a reader for a known need is allowed: record it in the score summary. The number of **L** questions is evidence about English and goes in the summary.

2.4 Stopping rules

- In every part, a student may stop when they have done what they can. Encourage once ("Have a look at the next one; some are easier"), then accept their decision.
- **Listening:** always read the whole script twice, even if the student writes nothing.
- **Reading:** let the student work for the full 12 minutes. Stop early only if the student has answered nothing in Part A after 4 minutes, or is upset; record "stopped after 4 minutes".
- **Writing:** if the student cannot start, say once: "You can write words, or draw and label your plan." Never write for them.
- **Maths and science:** stop at the time. A student who is stuck may be told: "You can go on to the next question."
- A distressed child is never pressed: stop, take a break or end the session, and record it.

2.5 Keeping the student at ease

- Sit beside rather than opposite if you can. Smile, use the student's name, and praise effort ("Thank you, you are working hard"), not answers.
- Do not show marks or say whether an answer is right.
- Say how many parts are left. Offer water and the break after the writing.

3. English

3.1 Listening (5 minutes, / 8)

Say: "Turn to page 2. I am going to read a message from a teacher, Mr Chen, to his class. First I will read the questions to you. Then I will read the message two times. You can answer while I read. Answer on pages 2 and 3."

Read the questions aloud once, slowly, pointing to each number. Do not name or explain the pictures.

> "Question 1. How will the class travel to the museum? Tick one box. Question 2. What time does the bus leave school? Tick one box. Question 3. What must the children bring? Tick two boxes. Question 4. What will the class visit first? Tick one box. Question 5. How many children will be in each group? Question 6. How much does the trip cost? Question 7. Mr Chen says, 'Don't worry if it rains.' Why does he say this? Question 8. Will the children buy lunch at the museum? Tick yes or no. How do you know?"

Say: "Now listen. I will read the message two times."

Read it twice at a natural, steady pace. Pause for about 3 seconds at each [pause]. After the first reading, wait 20 seconds, then say "Now listen again" and read it again. After the second reading, give one minute to finish.

> **Mr Chen:** Good morning, everyone. I have some news about our class trip. [pause]
>
> Next Thursday, we are going to the City Science Museum. We will go there by bus. The bus leaves school at half past eight, so please be at school by a quarter past eight. [pause]
>
> Please wear your sports clothes and comfortable shoes, because we will walk a lot. Bring a water bottle and a packed lunch. You do not need to bring any money on the day. [pause]
>
> At the museum, we will visit the space room first. After that, we will go to the robot workshop. There, you will build a small robot in groups of four. [pause]
>
> The trip costs forty yuan. Please ask your parents to pay by Monday. [pause]
>
> We will be back at school at three o'clock. And don't worry if it rains. Everything at the museum is inside. [pause]
>
> I am sure it will be a great day.

Answers. 1 mark each. Spelling and grammar are not marked in listening; the answer must be in English and the meaning must be clear.

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept	What it tests
1	**A** bus			key word
2	**B** 8:30		A 8:15 (the time to arrive at school)	a time; "half past"
3	**A** water bottle and **C** lunch box	both ticked and nothing else	money (they were told not to bring it), umbrella	two details; a negative ("do not need")
4	**A** space		B robots (that is second)	order words: "first", "after that"
5	**4**	four		number
6	**40**	¥40, 40 yuan, forty	14 (fourteen and forty sound alike)	number
7	Everything at the museum is inside, so the rain does not matter	"inside"; "they are inside"; "they will not get wet"	"it rains"; "bring an umbrella"	inference: links two sentences
8	**No**, because they bring a packed lunch, or because they do not need money	No with either reason; a reason without the tick if the meaning is clear ("no, they bring lunch")	Yes; No with no reason or a wrong reason	inference

Band guide

Score	0 to 2	3 to 4	5 to 6	7	8
Listening band	**A**	**B**	**C**	**D**	**E**

What to look for

- Questions 1 to 4 need key words and pictures only. A student who gets these but none of 5 to 8 usually knows familiar words but cannot yet follow connected speech (band B).
- The distractors in 2 (8:15) and 3 (money) show whether the student hears the words around a key word ("be at school by", "do not need").
- Questions 7 and 8 need two ideas linked: they separate D from E.
- Compare with "listening in conversation" on the interview record.

3.2 Reading paper (12 minutes, / 24)

Say: "Turn to page 4. This is the reading. There are three parts: A, B and C. Read the texts and answer the questions. Part C is hard. Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish. I cannot help you with the words, but I can say the instructions again. You have 12 minutes."

Start the timer. Say "Two minutes left" at 10 minutes and "Please stop" at 12 minutes. Do not read any text or question aloud and do not explain words.

Marking. Spelling is not marked unless the word cannot be recognised. For "find and copy" the word must be the right word from the text; a small copying slip is fine. Answers must be in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0.

Part A: the park notice (questions 1 to 6, / 8)

Q	Marks	Answer	Also accept	Notes
1	1	8:00		18:00 is the closing time
2	2	swings, picnic, feed ducks	Score = correct ticks minus wrong ticks: 3 gives 2 marks, 2 gives 1 mark, 1 or less gives 0	The pictures match the notice; the skill is "you can" against "please do not"
3	1	¥2	2, 2 yuan	
4	1	at the café	cafe, the cafe, café shop	"the office", "the shop" (not in the text)
5	2	swim in the lake: **False**; open on Sundays: **True**	1 mark each	"Sundays" needs the reader to use "every day"
6	1	the office by the main gate	office; main gate; gate office	the café

Part B: Silkworms (questions 7 to 14, / 8). A text about two years below age level.

Q	Marks	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
7	1	smaller than a grain of rice		
8	1	10	ten; about ten	4 (weeks), 2 (weeks)
9	1	black		white (the grown silkworm)
10	1	mulberry leaves	mulberry; leaves from a mulberry tree	"leaves" on its own
11	1	They eat a lot.		
12	1	cocoon	cocon, cocoon (small copying slips)	thread, silk
13	1	Boxes read **2, 4, 1, 3** (silkworm 2, moth 4, eggs 1, cocoon 3)	all four correct for the mark	
14	1	silk	silk clothes	"clothes" on its own

Part C: The Snowman at the Window (questions 15 to 22, / 8). Age-appropriate fiction for a fluent reader of 9.

Q	Marks	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
15	1	retrieval	the biggest snowman in the building	the biggest snowman; a big snowman; a snowman	"a snowball"
16	1	retrieval	Her legs were not strong any more.	her legs are weak; she could not walk on the ice; she might fall	"it was cold"; "she was watching the snow"
17	1	vocabulary	silent		soft; quiet (not in the paragraph)
18	1	vocabulary in context	breathing fast and hard		
19	1	inference	She was lonely and a little sad.		
20	1	inference with evidence	happy (or surprised, delighted), because she laughed, or pressed her hand against the window, or her face changed	any suitable feeling with a reason from the story	a feeling with no reason; "sad"
21	1	inference	So that Mrs Zhao could see it from her window	to make her happy; because she could not go outside to see the snow; it was a present for her	"because the snowball was too heavy"
22	1	why do you think	It made Mrs Zhao happy: it was for someone else, and being kind matters more than being the biggest	any answer about kindness, making someone happy or thinking of others	"it had a scarf"; "it was smaller" with no reason

Band guide

Result	Band
Part A under 4	**A** New to English
Part A 4 or more, Part B under 4	**B** Early acquisition
Part B 4 or more, Part C under 3	**C** Developing competence
Part C 3 to 5	**D** Competent
Part C 6 to 8	**E** Fluent

Use judgement when a result is uneven (for example, Part C higher than Part B), and check against the sentence reading screen.

What to look for

- **Picture support.** A student who scores only on questions 1, 2 and 5 may be using the pictures, not the words.
- **Copying.** In Parts B and C, a pattern of copying words that sit next to the question words (for example "small insects" for question 7) suggests word matching without understanding.
- **Inference.** Questions 20 to 22 separate D from E. A student at band C often gets the retrieval questions and leaves the "why" questions blank.
- **Speed.** A student who is accurate but does not reach Part C may decode slowly: check the fluency rating on the sentence reading record before giving a low band.

3.3 Writing (10 minutes, / 16)

Say: "Turn to page 10. This is the writing. Choose A or B, and tick the one you choose. You can plan in the box on page 11, then write on the lines. Write as much as you can. You have 10 minutes."

The task. A: a story about a child who finds a message in a bottle on a beach (picture and question prompts). B: "My favourite place", a description with question prompts. Both give a fair chance to show narrative or descriptive writing; do not give a higher mark for either choice.

Criteria. Score each criterion 0 to 4 (1 and 3 sit between the descriptions). Total / 16.

Criterion	0	2	4
Content and organisation	Nothing in English, or only words copied from the page	A few connected ideas on the topic in a simple order; may be short (3 to 5 sentences) or a list	A complete piece that fits the task: a story with an opening, a problem and an ending, or a description with several developed points; ideas link across sentences; paragraphs or clear sections
Vocabulary	No English words, or single words not on the topic	Everyday words that carry the meaning; a few topic words; much repetition (nice, good, big)	Varied, precise words for a 9 year old: chosen verbs, adjectives and adverbs; some ambitious words used correctly
Grammar and sentences	No sentences	Simple sentences with mostly correct word order, joined with and, then, because; frequent errors in tense, plurals and articles, but the meaning is clear	Different sentence types (with when, if, because, so, after); tense kept consistent; errors are rare and do not affect meaning
Spelling and punctuation	Spelling cannot be read; no punctuation	Common words mostly correct, others spelt as they sound; capital letters and full stops sometimes	Most words correct, including less common ones; full stops and capitals secure; commas, question marks and speech marks mostly correct

The writing band is given by best fit with the descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 6, not by the total alone. As a rough guide only: totals of 0 to 3 usually fit **A**, 4 to 7 **B**, 8 to 10 **C**, 11 to 13 **D**, 14 to 16 **E**.

Band E at this age. A fluent writer of 9 to 10 usually writes about 100 to 180 words in 10 minutes. The piece has an opening and an ending, is in paragraphs or clear sections, uses some varied sentences ("When she opened the bottle, ...", "Suddenly, ..."), descriptive words, and in a story some speech with speech marks (not always correct). Common words are spelt correctly and harder words are spelt plausibly. The errors are the ones any 9 year old makes, not the features of a learner of English (missing "a" and "the", missing past tense -ed or plural -s, Chinese word order).

What to look for

- **Learner features** (missing -s, -ed, articles; "I very like") point to C or D even when the content is good.
- **Memorised chunks** ("My name is ... I am 9 years old. I like ...") with little else usually fit B.
- **A full plan and little writing** may mean slow writing in English rather than no ideas: say so in the notes.

3.4 Speaking: the interview (about 8 minutes of questions)

Use `forms/Interview_Record_Y5_Y6`. The interviewer records the speaking band and "listening in conversation" on that form; copy the speaking band into Section 6. If the listening task (3.1) and listening in conversation differ by more than one band, note why (for example, the student relies on gesture and context in conversation).

3.5 Reading aloud: the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (opens the interview, 3 to 4 minutes)

Use `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card` and `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record`. **Start at Level 4 (sentence 10)** for Year 5. If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1. Follow the record's rules for going back, stopping and the meaning checks. Copy the total points (/ 72), reading age, meaning checks and fluency rating into Section 6. Use the "Years 3 to 5" column of the record's table to turn the reading age into an indicative band, and use it to confirm the reading paper band.

4. Maths (18 minutes, / 25)

Say: "Turn to page 12. This is maths. Section A is number problems. Section B is word problems and pictures. You can use a pencil, a rubber and a ruler. If you want me to read a question to you, put up your hand. You have 18 minutes."

What it tests. UK Year 4 content, with easier floor items (Year 3) and ceiling items (Year 5). Section A, number problems: 10 marks. Section B, word problems and pictures: 15 marks, of which **word problems: 5 marks** (questions

10, 12, 13 and 19b). Every Section B question has a picture, chart, table or diagram.

Marking. Give the mark for a correct answer with or without working. Units are printed in the answer boxes, so they are not needed. Accept answers in a different but correct form unless the question asks for a particular form.

4.1 Section A: number problems (/ 10)

Q	Content (UK year)	Marks	Answer	Also accept, partial credit	Common wrong answers and what they mean	May not have been taught (Chinese Grade 3 completed)
1	Add 3-digit numbers (Y3, floor)	1	594		584, 514: carrying slips	
2	Times table (Y3, floor)	1	56			
3	Subtract 4-digit numbers with exchange (Y4)	1	3 264	3264	4 744: subtracts the smaller digit from the larger in each column; 3 364: exchange slip	
4	12 times table (Y4)	1	72		62	The 11 and 12 times tables are often not learnt (tables go to 9 × 9). A student who works it out (10 × 6 + 2 × 6) is reasoning well.
5	3-digit × 1-digit (Y4)	1	972		962, 872: forgets a carried digit	
6	Hundredths as a decimal (Y4)	1	0.47	.47	4.7, 47.0, 0.047	Grade 3 meets tenths, often through money; hundredths are usually Grade 4.
7	Equivalent fractions (Y4)	1	9		3, 11: adds or copies the numerator	Equivalent fractions (分数的基本性质) are usually Grade 5.
8	Round to 10, 100 and 1 000 (Y4)	2	4 360; 4 400; 4 000	2 marks: all three; 1 mark: two correct	4 300 for the nearest 100: cuts off the digits instead of rounding	Rounding to the nearest 10, 100, 1 000 (四舍五入) is usually Grade 4, with large numbers; estimation (估算) is met earlier.
9	2-digit × 2-digit (Y5, ceiling)	1	864		216: multiplies by 2 instead of 20 in the second row	Usually taught in Grade 3 (两位数乘两位数), so many students will get this.

4.2 Section B: word problems and pictures (/ 15)

W = word problem.

Q	Content (UK year)	Marks	Answer	Also accept, partial credit	Common wrong answers and what they mean	May not have been taught
10 W	Division in context (Y3, floor)	1	12 tables	12	104 (adds), 88 (subtracts): did not understand "each"	
11	Bar chart with a scale in 5s (Y3 and Y4)	2	(a) 35 (b) 15	1 mark each	(a) 30 or 40: reads to the wrong line; (b) 45 (adds) or 30 (reads Thursday only)	Bar charts with a scale are often Grade 4; simple tables are Grade 2.

Q	Content (UK year)	Marks	Answer	Also accept, partial credit	Common wrong answers and what they mean	May not have been taught
12 W	Measures: m to cm, subtraction (Y4)	1	135 cm	1 m 35 cm	1.35 (works in metres but the box says cm: 0, note it), 145, 265 (adds)	
13 W	Money, two steps (Y3 and Y4)	2	¥117	2 marks: 117. 1 mark: 133 (85 + 48) or 165 (250 – 85) seen with no correct second step, or a correct method with one arithmetic slip	383 (adds everything)	
14	Area by counting squares and perimeter (Y3 and Y4)	2	(a) 14 cm^2 (b) 22 cm	1 mark each; units not needed	(a) 18: counts the gap; (b) 18: misses the edges inside the gap; 14 for (b): confuses perimeter with area	Area and perimeter are Grade 3, so these should be familiar.
15	Acute, obtuse and right angles (Y4)	1	A obtuse, B acute, C right	all three for the mark; spelling not marked	C acute: the right angle is drawn turned, so the student must judge it, not rely on horizontal and vertical lines	Angle types (锐角, 钝角, 直角) are Grade 2; the English words may be new.
16	Types of triangle and quadrilateral (Y4)	1	A isosceles triangle, B parallelogram, C trapezium	all three joins correct	B and C swapped	The shapes are usually Grade 4 (三角形; 平行四边形和梯形); the English names may be new. A Chinese reading of the question names the shapes, so mark L.
17	Complete a symmetric shape (Y4)	1	The right half mirrors the left. From the top of the mirror line, a slanted line goes to the point 3 squares right and 3 squares down; then 1 square back towards the line; then 2 squares down; then 2 squares along the bottom back to the line. The finished shape is an arrow pointing up.	Small drawing inaccuracy if every corner is in the right square; shading not needed	A copy slid across instead of a mirror image	Line symmetry is often met in Grade 2; it may not have been practised on a grid.

Q	Content (UK year)	Marks	Answer	Also accept, partial credit	Common wrong answers and what they mean	May not have been taught
18	Coordinates and translation (Y4)	2	(a) (3, 6) (b) (7, 4)	1 mark each; (b) follow-through: if (a) is wrong, award (b) for their point moved 4 right and 2 down	(6, 3): reverses the order; (b) (−1, 8) or (7, 8): wrong direction	Coordinates are usually Grade 7. Some textbooks use number pairs (数对: column, then row) in Grade 5, which is the same order as (x, y).
19	Negative numbers on a thermometer (Y4; (b) is a Y5 ceiling item)	2	(a) −4 °C (b) 3 °C; (b) is a word problem	1 mark each; "minus 4", "4 below zero"	(a) 4: no minus sign; (b) 11 (adds 4 and 7), −11, −3 (counts the wrong way)	Negative numbers are usually Grade 6. Students from northern China often know "零下" temperatures from weather reports.

Band guide (provisional)

Score / 25	0 to 9	10 to 14	15 to 21	22 to 25
Maths band	**1** Well below expected	**2** Working towards	**3** Expected	**4** Greater depth

List the NT questions and judge whether the student would reach band 3 once taught.

Topics that may not have been taught to a student who has completed Chinese Grade 3: the 11 and 12 times tables (4), hundredths (6), equivalent fractions (7), rounding (8), bar charts with a scale (11), the names of triangles and quadrilaterals (16), coordinates (18) and negative numbers (19). Calculation (1 to 3, 5, 9), measures, money, area and perimeter (10, 12 to 14) are usually taught by the end of Grade 3. Textbooks differ (PEP, 苏教版, 北师大版), so always ask the student.

4.3 What to look for

- **Number problems against word problems.** A student who scores well on number problems (Section A) but poorly on the word problems (10, 12, 13, 19b) may have an English barrier rather than a maths difficulty. Check by reading the word problem aloud (and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese, marked L). If the answer then comes quickly, record it as an English barrier.
- **Method.** Students from Chinese schools often calculate quickly and accurately in their heads or in neat columns. A correct answer without working is fine. Look at the working when an answer is wrong: one slip in a sound method is a different need from a wrong method.
- **Conventions.** Reading a scale in 5s, "Not drawn accurately", coordinates in brackets and the UK names of shapes may be new. A student who shows the maths correctly with a picture or working knows the maths, even if the English words are new.

5. Science (8 minutes, / 10)

Say: "Turn to page 18. This is science. Every question has a picture. If you want me to read a question to you, put up your hand. You have 8 minutes."

What it tests. UK Year 4 science and working scientifically. Question 7 is the fair test and table question.

Q	Content (UK year)	Marks	Answer	Also accept, partial credit	Common wrong answers	May not have been taught
1	Solids, liquids and gases (Y4)	1	A solid, B liquid, C gas	all three for the mark, in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0	"ice" or "water" written in the box: describes, does not classify	The states of water (水的三态) are often taught by Grade 3, but the English words may be new.
2	Teeth (Y4)	1	incisor: cuts food; canine: tears food; molar: chews and crushes food	all three joins correct	incisor and canine swapped	Teeth and digestion are often Grade 4.
3	Classification key (Y4)	1	A beetle, B earthworm	both; spelling not marked ("bettle", "earth worm")	A spider: did not count the legs (6)	Branching keys are less common in Chinese textbooks.
4	Food chains (Y4)	2	(a) rice plant → grasshopper → frog → snake (b) more grasshoppers	1 mark each; (a) accept "rice"; all four in order	(a) reversed (snake first): knows who eats whom but not the arrow convention, note it; (b) fewer	Food chains are often Grade 5.
5	Sound comes from vibration (Y4)	1	The top of the drum vibrates.		"The stick hits the rice."	Sound is usually Grade 4, so may not have been taught; the rice on a drum is a common Chinese classroom demonstration.
6	Circuits; conductors and insulators (Y4)	2	(a) B (b) metal paper clip	1 mark each	(a) C: thinks a switch always lets electricity through; (b) any other: does not link metal with conducting	Simple circuits are usually Grade 4, so may not have been taught.
7	Evaporation: reading a table, fair test (Y4, working scientifically)	2	(a) A sunny window (b) any one: the same amount of water at the start; the same size or kind of dish; the same time (2 days); measure in the same way	1 mark each; (b) "same water", "same dish", "same cup"	(a) C fridge: chooses the largest number, check that the student read "water after 2 days"; (b) "same place" or "same temperature" (those are what changes)	Fair testing in this form is less familiar; evaporation (蒸发) is often taught by Grade 3.

Band guide (provisional)

Score / 10	0 to 3	4 to 5	6 to 8	9 to 10
Science band	**1** Well below expected	**2** Working towards	**3** Expected	**4** Greater depth

What to look for

- **Working scientifically.** Question 7 shows scientific thinking separately from topic knowledge. A student who gets 7 right but marks other questions NT is likely to do well once taught.
- **An English barrier** looks like wrong answers that depend on a single English word (solid, liquid, gas in 1; beetle in 3; vibrates in 5) while the picture questions (4, 6) are right. Reading the question aloud, or once in Chinese (L), usually settles it.

- **Everyday ideas** (for example "the stick hits the rice") are a science misconception, not an English problem.

6. Score summary

Complete on the day and copy onto `forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`.

Candidate name	
Date of birth	
Year group applied for	
Current school	
Date of assessment	
Assessor	

Part	Score	Band	Notes (NT, L, access arrangements, behaviour)
Listening	/ 8	A B C D E	
Reading paper	/ 24 (A / 8, B / 8, C / 8)	A B C D E	
Sentence reading (shared record)	points / 72; reading age _____ ; meaning checks ___ ; fluency ___	indicative A B C D E	
Writing	/ 16 (content __ vocabulary __ grammar __ spelling __)	A B C D E	
Speaking (from the interview)		A B C D E	
Maths	/ 25 (A / 10, B / 15, of which word problems / 5)	1 2 3 4	NT: L:
Science	/ 10	1 2 3 4	NT: L:

Overall English band (the band most of the four skills sit in; name any skill two or more bands lower)	A B C D E
Number problems against word problems (Section A / 10, word problems / 5): English barrier in maths?	yes / no / unsure
Access arrangements (extra time, reader, breaks)	
Behaviour and wellbeing during the assessment	

Assessor's comment (strengths, gaps, NT topics, English barrier or not) _____

_____

Assessor signature and date _____

Graded Sentence Reading Screen: assessor record

Candidate name	
Date of birth	
Age today (years:months)	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Assessor	

What it is. A quick 1:1 read-aloud screen for every candidate from Year 1 to Year 10. The student reads sentences that get harder, from a reading age of about 5 to adult level, until they can no longer read them. It gives an **indicative reading age**, an accuracy profile, a **fluency** rating and an **understanding** check. It takes 2 to 6 minutes. In Years 1 to 3 it follows the Early Reading Screen; from Year 4 it opens the interview.

You need: the student card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`), this record, a pencil, and a plain card or sheet of paper to cover the sentences the student has not reached yet (this stops a page of text looking frightening).

1. Start, carry on, stop

Year applied for	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Start at level	1	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
First sentence	1	1	4	7	10	13	16	19	22	25

- If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1 whatever their age.
- **Going back (basal).** If the student scores 6 out of 6 on the start level, give full credit (6 points) for every level below it. If they score less than 6, go back one level at a time until they score 6 out of 6 on a level (or you reach Level 1). Then carry on upwards from the level after the start level.
- **Stopping (ceiling).** Always finish the start level. Then stop at the end of any level where the student scores **2 points or fewer**. Stop straight away if the student scores 0 on **three sentences in a row**, or if they become upset. Levels above the stopping point score 0.

Say: "I would like you to read some sentences out loud for me. They start easy and get harder. When they get too hard, that is fine, we will stop. If you do not know a word, have a go. Ready?" Point to the first sentence. You may say "Have a go" or "Try the next word". Do not sound out, explain or translate any word.

2. Scoring each sentence

Errors in the sentence	Points
none (self-corrections are fine)	**2**
one	**1**
two or more	**0**

These count as one error each

Code	Error	Example
S	**Substitution**: says a different word or a non-word	"horse" for house; "sur-pried" for surprised
O	**Omission**: leaves out a word, or leaves off a written ending that changes the word (-s, -ed, -ing, -ly)	"The frog jump out" for jumped
I	**Insertion**: adds a word that is not there	"the a red bus"

Code	Error	Example
T	**Told**: no attempt after about 5 seconds; say the word, mark T	
	Two words read in the wrong order	one error

These are not errors (mark them, but do not count them)

Code	What happens	Why it is not an error
SC	**Self-correction**: reads a word wrongly, then puts it right	The student is checking meaning.
R	**Repetition** of a word or phrase	
	Pauses, or sounding out and then blending the word correctly	Note it for fluency instead.
	Accent and pronunciation features common for speakers of Chinese, when the word is still clearly the right word: l and r ("lice" for rice), n and l, v and w, th as s, f, d or z ("sink" for think), a light or missing final consonant sound, an extra vowel after a final consonant ("bed-uh"), the -ed ending said in full ("jump-ed"), stress on a different syllable ("ho-TEL", "PHO-to-graph")	These are features of a learner's spoken English, not of reading. If the sound changes the word into a different word that makes sense, and you cannot tell which was meant, count it.
	Names (Ling, Jun, Mei) read in any reasonable way	
	Reading the British spelling as written ("tyres", "colour")	

When you are not sure, give the student the benefit of the doubt and write what they said in the notes. Patterns in the notes (for example missing -ed endings throughout, or pinyin letter values such as "i" read as in pinyin) are useful evidence for the English profile.

3. Understanding (the meaning check)

After each level the student reads with **3 or more points**, ask the meaning question for that level (printed in the record). Read the question aloud once and let the student answer in their own words. Record ✓ (understood), **½** (partly) or ✗ (not understood). The answer must be in English: one word or a short phrase is enough, and pointing to the right words in the sentence also counts. An answer in Chinese is recorded ✗.

4. Fluency

Rate the student's reading on the **last level they read with 4 or more points**.

Rating	What it sounds like
1	Word by word. Long pauses. Little sense of the sentence as a whole.
2	Mostly two- or three-word groups, with some word-by-word reading. Little expression.
3	Mostly in sensible phrases. Some pauses to work out harder words. The sentence makes sense to the listener.
4	Smooth and phrased, close to natural speech, with stress and expression that show understanding.

5. Record

Level 1 (sentences 1 to 3)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
1	I can see a red bus.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
2	The cat sat on my bed.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
3	Dad has a big hat.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 2): "Where did the cat sit?" *Accept: On the bed, on my bed.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 2 (sentences 4 to 6)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
4	We went to the shop to get some milk.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
5	The frog jumped out of the pond.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
6	They like to play in the park.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 4): "What did they go to the shop to get?" *Accept: Milk.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 3 (sentences 7 to 9)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
7	Ling put on her coat because it was cold outside.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
8	The little boat floated slowly down the river.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
9	Grandma made noodles for everyone at the party.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 7): "Why did Ling put on her coat?" *Accept: Because it was cold (outside).*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 4 (sentences 10 to 12)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
10	After school, Jun and his friends played football on the green field.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
11	The children could hear the water splashing against the rocks.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
12	Most people carry an umbrella when the clouds turn grey.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 11): "What could the children hear?" *Accept: Water splashing (on the rocks), the sea or river hitting the rocks.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 5 (sentences 13 to 15)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
13	Mei was surprised to find a tiny kitten hiding behind the library door.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
14	Before the long journey, Dad checked that the tyres had enough air.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
15	The strange noise in the kitchen turned out to be a hungry mouse.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 14): "What did Dad check before the journey?" *Accept: The tyres; that the tyres had enough air.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 6 (sentences 16 to 18)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
16	Although the mountain path was difficult, the whole class reached the top before noon.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
17	The museum guide explained how early people made tools from stone and bone.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
18	My favourite season is autumn, when the leaves change colour and the air feels fresh.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 18): "What happens to the leaves in autumn?" *Accept: They change colour (accept: they turn red, yellow or brown).*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 7 (sentences 19 to 21)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
19	The weather forecast warned that the temperature would drop sharply during the night.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
20	Our neighbour immediately recognised the voice on the telephone and smiled.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
21	The community worked together to clean the river and protect the local environment.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 19): "What did the weather forecast say?" *Accept: It will get much colder at night; the temperature will go down a lot.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 8 (sentences 22 to 24)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
22	The scientists collected evidence carefully before they announced the results of their experiment.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
23	A queue of excited passengers waited patiently on the platform for the delayed train.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
24	The ancient bridge, which was built from enormous stones, has survived for centuries.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 23): "Why were the passengers waiting?" *Accept: Their train was late (delayed).*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 9 (sentences 25 to 27)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
25	The orchestra rehearsed for several weeks to perfect the rhythm of the challenging final movement.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
26	Volunteers distributed warm blankets and hot drinks to the runners who had finished the marathon.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
27	Although the explanation seemed reasonable, the detective suspected that the witness was not telling the truth.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 27): "What did the detective think about the witness?" *Accept: The witness was lying, or not telling the whole truth.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 10 (sentences 28 to 30)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
28	The architect's design was praised for combining traditional courtyards with sustainable, energy-saving technology.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
29	Researchers are investigating whether the mysterious behaviour of the birds is caused by changes in climate.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
30	The committee unanimously agreed that the proposal was too expensive and would require further consideration.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 29): "What are the researchers trying to find out?" *Accept: Whether climate change is the reason the birds behave strangely.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 11 (sentences 31 to 33)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
31	The psychologist's analysis suggested that the athlete's anxiety was caused by an unconscious fear of failure.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
32	Meticulous archaeologists spent months excavating the tomb, revealing exquisite pottery and bronze ornaments.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
33	The government's ambitious infrastructure programme has transformed transport links between rural and urban regions.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 32): "What did the archaeologists find?" *Accept: Beautiful (very fine) pottery and bronze ornaments, in a tomb.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 12 (sentences 34 to 36)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
34	The connoisseur's idiosyncratic taste baffled the gallery owner, who had anticipated a more conventional choice.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
35	Despite the ostensibly benign forecast, the meteorologist remained sceptical and recommended a thorough reassessment.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
36	The philosopher's paradoxical aphorisms were considered unfathomable by most of her contemporaries.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 35): "How did the meteorologist feel about the forecast?" *Accept: Did not believe it, doubted it, wanted it checked again.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

6. Reading age

Total points = points scored + 6 for every level below the basal level that was not read.

Reading age (years:months) = 5:00 + 2 months for every point (0 points: below 5:00). So 6 points = 6:00 (Level 1 secure), 12 points = 7:00, 30 points = 10:00, 60 points = 15:00, 72 points = 17:00 (the ceiling: report "16 years or above" for 66 points or more).

Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age
1	5:02	13	7:02	25	9:02	37	11:02	49	13:02	61	15:02
2	5:04	14	7:04	26	9:04	38	11:04	50	13:04	62	15:04
3	5:06	15	7:06	27	9:06	39	11:06	51	13:06	63	15:06
4	5:08	16	7:08	28	9:08	40	11:08	52	13:08	64	15:08
5	5:10	17	7:10	29	9:10	41	11:10	53	13:10	65	15:10
6	6:00	18	8:00	30	10:00	42	12:00	54	14:00	66	16:00
7	6:02	19	8:02	31	10:02	43	12:02	55	14:02	67	16:02
8	6:04	20	8:04	32	10:04	44	12:04	56	14:04	68	16:04
9	6:06	21	8:06	33	10:06	45	12:06	57	14:06	69	16:06
10	6:08	22	8:08	34	10:08	46	12:08	58	14:08	70	16:08
11	6:10	23	8:10	35	10:10	47	12:10	59	14:10	71	16:10
12	7:00	24	9:00	36	11:00	48	13:00	60	15:00	72	17:00

Total points	/ 72
Reading age	
Actual age (years:months)	
Difference (reading age minus actual age)	
Meaning checks (levels asked, how many ✓)	
Fluency rating (1 to 4)	
Patterns noticed	

7. What the result means

This screen is not standardised. The reading ages come from the way the sentences were built (how common the words are, the spelling patterns in the English National Curriculum word lists for each year, and the length and

structure of the sentences). Treat a reading age as a range of about 6 months either side. Once 30 to 50 students have taken it, compare their reading ages with the reading paper and with how they get on in class, and adjust the guide below if needed.

The reading band. In Years 1 to 3 the reading band comes from the Early Reading Screen; in Years 4 to 10 from the reading paper. This screen confirms the band. Use the table as a guide; if this screen and the main reading result differ by more than one band, look for the reason (below).

Reading age compared with actual age	Years 3 to 5	Years 6 to 10
At or above actual age, or close below it	up to 6 months below: **E**	up to 12 months below: **E**
Below	7 to 12 months below: **D**	13 to 24 months below: **D**
Well below	13 to 24 months below: **C**	25 to 42 months below: **C**
Far below	25 to 36 months below: **B**	43 to 60 months below: **B**
Very far below, or Level 1 not secure	more than 36 months below: **A**	more than 60 months below: **A**

- **Years 1 and 2.** Many fluent English speakers score 0 to 6 points at the start of Year 1. At the start of Year 2 a fluent reader usually has Level 1 secure and often Level 2. Use the reading age as supporting evidence only.
- **Decoding ahead of understanding.** If the meaning checks on the last two levels read are mostly ✗, move the band down one. This is common for students who learnt phonics or the phonetic alphabet well but have a small English vocabulary: they can "say" words they do not know.
- **Understanding ahead of decoding.** A student who understands well (✓ throughout) but stops early on long, rare words may be a confident English user who has had little reading practice, or may have a specific difficulty with reading. Look at the Early Reading Screen or the reading paper and, if there is a pattern, raise it in the summary.
- **Low fluency** (rating 1 or 2) with a good reading age often means effortful decoding: the student will find long texts in English tiring at first.
- **Level 1 not secure** at any age: use the letter sounds and Section 1 words of the Early Reading Screen to find what the student knows.

Copy to the Candidate Summary: total points, reading age, actual age, meaning checks, fluency, indicative band, one line on patterns.

Student interview and suitability record: Years 5 and 6

Candidate name	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Interviewer	
Others present (for example receiving homeroom teacher; Chinese-speaking colleague)	

About 12 minutes, 1:1. The interview is held **in English**. It has three jobs: to hear the student's spoken English (the speaking band), to get to know the student (interests, learning, wellbeing, **future plans and aspirations**), and to judge their **suitability** for the international programme. It opens with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (start Level 4 for Year 5, Level 5 for Year 6; record on `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record.md`).

How to ask. Smile, sit beside rather than opposite the child if you can, and start with something easy. Ask the main question first. If the child struggles, use the **easier** prompt (a yes or no, or a choice). If they answer easily, use the **stretch** prompt. Wait at least five seconds before rephrasing. Answers must be in English.

Safeguarding. Keep the door open or another adult present. If a child tells you something that worries you about their safety or wellbeing, do not promise to keep it secret; listen, write down their words, and pass it to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day.

1. Sentence reading (3 to 4 minutes)

Total points ___ / 72 Reading age _____ Meaning checks ___ Fluency ___ (details on the sentence reading record)

2. Questions (8 minutes)

Choose about two questions from each block. Tick the ones you used and write short notes: what they said, and how they said it.

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch	Notes
Warm-up	Tell me about yourself and your family.	What is your name? Do you have a brother or sister?	What do you like doing together as a family?	
	What did you do last weekend?	Did you go out or stay at home?	What was the best part, and why?	
School and learning	Tell me about your school now.	Do you like your school? What is your favourite subject?	What is one thing you would change about it?	
	What do you find hard at school? What do you do then?	Is maths easy or hard for you?	Tell me about a time you learnt something hard.	
	How do you learn English now?	Do you have English lessons? Do you read English books?	What helps you remember new words?	
	How do you feel about having all your lessons in English?	Are you worried, excited, or both?	What do you think will be hardest?	
Interests	What do you like to do after school and at weekends?	Do you like sport, music, art or games?	What are you best at, and how did you get good at it?	

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch	Notes
	Tell me about a book, film or game you like.	Do you like reading?	Why do you like it? Who would you recommend it to?	
	How many classes or tutoring sessions do you have after school?	Do you have classes at the weekend?	How do you feel about it?	
Friends and feelings	Tell me about your friends.	Do you have a best friend?	What makes someone a good friend?	
	What do you do when you feel sad or worried?	Who do you talk to?		
	How do you feel about starting a new school?	Are you happy, nervous, or both?	What would help you settle in?	
Future plans and aspirations	What would you like to be when you grow up? Why?	Do you have a dream job?	What do you need to learn to do that job?	
	Is there a place in the world you would like to visit or live in?	China or another country?	What do you think it would be like?	
	Why do you want to come to our school?	Is it your idea or your parents' idea?	What do you hope to learn here?	
Values (choose one)	Your friend breaks a classmate's pencil and says nothing. What do you do?	Is that OK?	Why?	
	A new student cannot speak your language and sits alone. What do you do?	Would you play with them?	How could you help them?	
Questions for us	What would you like to ask me about the school?	Do you have any questions?		

3. Speaking band

Circle the band that fits best, for a child of this age.

Band	What you hear
A New to English	Little or no spoken English, or single words and memorised phrases. Relies on Chinese, gesture or silence. Understands very little unless supported with pictures or gesture.
B Early acquisition	Short answers and simple memorised sentences about familiar things (family, school, likes). Frequent errors. Needs the easier prompts. Understands slow, simple questions.
C Developing competence	Answers most main questions with short connected sentences ("because", "and then", "but"). Errors are frequent but meaning is usually clear. Everyday vocabulary.
D Competent	Talks easily and at some length, explains and gives examples, manages most stretch prompts. Occasional errors that rarely affect meaning.
E Fluent	Speaks as fluently and accurately as a fluent English speaker of the same age.

Speaking band: **A** **B** **C** **D** **E** Listening in conversation: **A** **B** **C** **D** **E**

Notes on pronunciation and intelligibility (pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the child is easy to understand):

4. Suitability

Rate each strand from what you saw and heard. **1** Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong. Write the evidence.

Strand	What strong looks like at this age	Rating	Evidence
Attitude to learning and resilience	Keen to learn, has a go, keeps trying when work is hard	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Curiosity and engagement	Asks questions, shows interest, enjoys talking about ideas	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Social and emotional readiness	Settles with a new adult, talks about friends, manages nerves, ready for a new school	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Independence and self-management	Follows instructions, looks after belongings, can work alone for a short time, will ask for help	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Values and conduct	Kind, honest and polite in the interview and the values question	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Readiness for English-medium learning	Happy to try speaking English even with mistakes, interested in learning English	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	

Boarding readiness (only if the child will board): independence with daily routines, sleep, homesickness, experience of being away from home. Rating ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 Evidence:

5. Anything to follow up

Area	Tick	Notes
Possible special educational need or disability (for example reading, attention, speech, hearing, vision, coordination)	☐	
Wellbeing (for example anxiety, very heavy after-school workload, sleep)	☐	
Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day)	☐	
Medical or dietary	☐	

6. Receiving homeroom teacher (optional)

If the child's likely homeroom teacher meets them, note first impressions and what the child would need in the first weeks (for example a buddy, a picture word book, seating near the teacher).

Interviewer signature and date _____

Parent conversation record

Candidate name	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Staff member	
Parents or carers present	
Language used (and interpreter if any)	

About 15 minutes. Hold it while the student does the written tasks with another adult, or straight after. Use the family's preferred language; a Chinese-speaking colleague should lead or interpret if the staff member does not speak Chinese. The aim is a two-way conversation: to understand the child and the family's hopes, to explain how the international programme works, and to check that what the family wants matches what the school offers. Do not discuss the assessment results on the day.

1. Why the international programme?

Question	Notes
Why are you looking for a place in the international programme, and why now?	
What do you know about how the programme works (lessons in English, the UK-style curriculum, assessment, homework, activities)?	
Whose idea is the move, and how does your child feel about it?	

2. Schooling so far

Question	Notes
Schools attended, years, and type (Chinese mainstream, bilingual, international, overseas)	
Any year repeated or skipped? Any long gaps?	
Why is the child leaving their current school?	
Student registration (学籍): where is it held now, and what will happen to it? (admissions office to give the school's position)	
School reports, certificates and any assessments the family can share	

3. Languages

Question	Notes
Which languages are spoken at home, and by whom?	
How has the child learnt English so far (school lessons from which grade, classes outside school, tutor, online, time abroad, English-speaking carer)? About how many hours a week?	
Does the child read in English at home? In Chinese?	
How will the family support English at home (reading, media, activities), and support Chinese if that matters to the family?	

4. Learning, health and development

Ask gently and explain why: the school wants to have the right support ready from the first day.

Question	Notes
What is your child good at? What do they enjoy most?	
Has any teacher or doctor ever raised a concern about learning, speech and language, attention, behaviour, hearing or vision? Any assessments or reports?	
Any extra help at the current school?	
Medical conditions, allergies, medication (also on the school medical form)	
For young children: speech in Chinese for their age, toilet and self-care, sleep	

5. Wellbeing and the week

Question	Notes
How would you describe your child's personality? How do they cope with change?	
Friendships: does your child make friends easily?	
A typical weekday and weekend: after-school classes, tutoring, sport, music, screen time, sleep	
Any big changes in the family recently (a move, a new baby, a parent working away)? Share only what you are comfortable sharing.	

6. Expectations and partnership

Question	Notes
What would make this a successful first year for your child?	
What do you expect from the school (homework, reports, communication, class rankings, exam results)? Explain how the school reports progress and how it communicates.	
How does the family feel about co-curricular activities, sport, arts, service and wellbeing as part of education, not just exam subjects?	
Learning in a new language takes time: explain what is typical (social English often within one to two years; the English needed for academic work often takes several years) and how the school supports it. How does the family feel about this?	
How would the family like to be involved (events, meetings, volunteering)?	

7. Future plans

Question	Notes
What are your hopes for your child in the long term (university, country, career)?	
Do you plan to stay in the international programme through to the end of school?	
Explain the programme's pathway (for example IGCSE, then the sixth form programme) and how it differs from the 中考 and 高考 route, using the admissions office's wording. Does the family understand that moving back to the national exam route later may not be straightforward?	
Year 10 applicants: which IGCSE subjects does the student hope to take? Explain that IGCSE is a two-year course starting in Year 10.	

8. Boarding (only if the child will board)

Question	Notes
Has the child stayed away from home before (camps, boarding, family)? How did it go?	
How independent are they with daily routines, sleep and belongings?	
How will the family keep in touch, and how often will the child go home?	

9. Questions from the family

10. Staff view

	Rating	Notes
Match between the family's expectations and what the programme offers	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Family's willingness to work in partnership with the school	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Information to follow up (reports, medical, assessments, 学籍)		

1 Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong.

Consent. The parent or carer agrees that the school may contact the current school (homeroom teacher) for a reference: **Yes** ☐ **No** ☐

Parent or carer signature _____

Staff signature and date _____

Candidate summary and decision

Candidate name	
Date of birth	
Year group applied for	
Current school	
Date of assessment	
Assessor	

Paper version sat: _____ (for example v3.1; it is on the front page and in the footer of every paper)

Complete within two working days, from the assessor booklet, reading records, interview record, parent conversation and homeroom teacher reference. The bands guide a professional decision; they are not a pass mark (guide, Sections 6 to 9).

1. English profile

Skill	Evidence (scores)	Band
Listening	Listening task ___ / ___ ; listening in conversation	**A B C D E**
Speaking	Interview (and picture talk, Years 1 to 3)	**A B C D E**
Reading	Years 1 to 3: Early Reading Screen book band _____ accuracy ___% questions ___ ; phonics words ___ / 40 ; letter sounds ___ / 26 and ___ / 18 ; tricky words ___ / 20. Years 4 to 6: reading paper ___ / 24 (A ___ B ___ C ___). Years 7 to 10: reading paper ___ / 16 (A ___ B ___)	**A B C D E**
Reading aloud	Sentence reading: points ___ / 72 ; reading age _____ ; actual age _____ ; meaning checks ___ ; fluency ___	indicative **A B C D E**
Writing	Writing task ___ / 16	**A B C D E**
Overall English	The band most of the four skills sit in. If one skill is two or more bands below the others, say which.	**A B C D E**

A New to English, **B** Early acquisition, **C** Developing competence, **D** Competent, **E** Fluent (comparable to a fluent English speaker of the same age).

2. Maths and science

	Score	Band	Number problems (Years 7 to 10: fluency)	Word problems (Years 7 to 10: word questions)	Applied (Years 7 to 10)	Not yet taught (NT)	Language support (L)
Maths	___ / ___	**1 2 3 4**	___ / ___	___ / ___	___ / 12		
Science (Years 5 to 10)	___ / ___	**1 2 3 4**					

1 Well below expected (Years 7 to 10: below expected), **2** Working towards, **3** Expected, **4** Greater depth. The Years 7 to 10 papers are harder, so their band boundaries are lower (guide and booklets). A student who does well on number problems but poorly on word problems may have an English barrier rather than a maths difficulty. In Years 7 to 10, a student strong in fluency and word questions but weak in applied problems needs teaching in problem solving, not more content. Questions marked NT score 0; say whether the student is likely to reach the expected band once taught.

Year 10 only: readiness for IGCSE (Year 10 assessor booklet, Section 6). English course: ☐ First Language ☐ English as a Second Language ☐ to decide. Maths tier: ☐ Extended ☐ Core ☐ to decide. Overall: ☐ Ready ☐ Ready with support ☐ Not yet.

Assessor's comment on maths and science (strengths, gaps, NT topics, English barrier or not):

3. Suitability

Source	Summary	Concerns (any strand rated 1)
Student interview (strands rated 1 to 4)		
Parent conversation (match of expectations, partnership)		
Previous homeroom teacher reference		
School reports and documents		
Follow-ups (special educational needs, wellbeing, medical, safeguarding referral made)		

4. Recommendation

Use the decision guide in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9. Tick one.

	Recommendation
☐	**Offer.** Ready to join the year group with normal class support.
☐	**Offer with English support.** Ready academically; needs a planned English programme (state the level below).
☐	**Offer with a learning plan.** Needs catch-up in named maths or science topics, or other planned support; review date set.
☐	**Further assessment before a decision.** For example a second visit, a trial day, a specialist assessment, or more information from the family or school.
☐	**Unable to offer at this time.** The programme cannot meet the student's needs now. Give the reason and, where possible, what would change the decision.

Year group confirmed: _____ (by age: yes / no; if no, give the reason and who approved it)

5. Support from the first day (if offered)

Area	Plan
English support level	☐ Intensive (new to English) ☐ Timetabled support lessons ☐ In-class support and monitoring ☐ None needed
Maths and science catch-up	
Reading (book band or reading age to start from)	
Pastoral (buddy, homeroom check-ins, boarding support)	
Information for the homeroom teacher	
Review date (for example after six weeks)	

6. Sign-off

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Assessor			
Head of section			
Admissions			
Outcome told to the family (start with the child's strengths)			